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AGENDA

IURA BOARD

8:30 A.M., Thursday, February 26, 2026

Common Council Chambers, Third Floor

108 E. Green St., Ithaca, NY 14850

Join Zoom Meeting: <https://us02web.zoom.us/j/83152691279?pwd=Nkd0SDVQUVNmT3dkNTVtVFg4UFdiQT09>

Meeting ID: 831 5269 1279 **Passcode:** QSB86B

Dial by Your Location: +1 646 558 8656 US (New York)

Meeting ID: 831 5269 1279

Phone Passcode: 726996

PUBLIC COMMENTS: **WRITTEN** public comments may be e-mailed until 3:00 p.m., the day *before* the meeting to: cpyott@cityofithaca.org. People who prefer to deliver **VERBAL** comments (3-min. max.) should either appear in person or use above Zoom link/log-in credentials (video) or dial-in number/log-in credentials (telephone).

I. Call to Order

II. Agenda Additions/Deletions

III. Public Comments (3 min. max.)

IV. Review of Meeting Minutes: January 22, 2026

V. New Business

- A. Independent Contractor Agreement for Accounting Services – Resolution

VI. Neighborhood Investment Committee

A. HUD Entitlement Grant

1. Designate INHS, Inc. as a CBDO and CHDO - Resolution
2. 2026 Funding Application Round – Report

B. Committee Vice-Chairperson Report

VII. Other/Old Business

- A. Reports from Mayor/IURA Chair, Common Council Liaison, & Staff
- B. Next Meeting Date: Public Hearing 1:00-4PM, Thursday, March 19, 2026

VIII. Adjournment



*If you have a disability and require accommodation to fully participate, please contact
CITY OF ITHACA CLERK'S OFFICE at 274-6570 at least 72 hours prior to meeting.*

DRAFT MINUTES

ITHACA URBAN RENEWAL AGENCY BOARD

9:00 A.M., Thursday, January 22nd, 2026

Common Council Chambers, Third Floor (City Hall)

108 E. Green St., Ithaca, NY 14850

IN-PERSON/HYBRID MEETING

Members: Robert G. Cantelmo (Mayor), Chair; Siobhan Hull; Donna Fleming

Excused: Karl Graham, Vice-Chair; Shaianne Osterreich

Vacancies: 0

Common Council Liaison: Excused.

IURA Staff: Nels Bohn; Anisa Mendizabal; Charles Pyott [virtual]

City Staff: None.

Guests: None.

I. Call to Order

Cantelmo called the meeting to order at 9:00 A.M.

II. Agenda Additions/Deletions

None.

III. Public Comments

None.

IV. Review of Meeting Minutes: December 18, 2025

Fleming moved, seconded by Hull, to approve the meeting minutes with no modifications.

Carried Unanimously: 3-0

V. Governance Committee (GC)

A. Procurement – Independent Contractors

1. Community Development Consulting: The Harrison Studio

Fleming explained there are three separate procurement contracts being reviewed and considered for approval. The first one is for a contract with H. Sicherman & Company, Inc./The Harrison Studio to provide community development consulting services (including loan underwriting analysis).

Fleming moved, seconded by Hull:

**2026 Procurement of Community Development Consulting Services —
H. Sicherman dba The Harrison Studio**

WHEREAS, the contract with H. Sicherman & Company, Inc./The Harrison Studio (Sicherman) providing community development consulting services, including loan underwriting, expires on February 29, 2026, and

WHEREAS, in accordance with IURA procurement policy and regulations contained in 2 CFR Part 200 for procurement of professional services, the IURA issued a competitive Request for Proposals for legal services on December 20, 2025, and

WHEREAS, the RFP was sent to the current IURA contractor, firms that indicated prior interest or responded to prior RFPs, and published as a legal ad in the Ithaca Journal, and

WHEREAS, the IURA received the following proposal:

- H. Sicherman & Company, Inc. dba The Harrison Studio

WHEREAS, whereas per applicable procurement regulations, a contractor selected through an initial competitive selection process may be renewed for up to two additional one-year terms without undertaking a new competitive selection process, and

WHEREAS, Sicherman submitted a proposal to continue providing community development services to the IURA in 2026 at the following hourly rates:

- \$175/hour – R. Charles Bell
- \$145/hour – Michael Thomas (loan underwriting), and

WHEREAS, the 2026 rates represent a 0.0% increase from the current contract rates for loan underwriting services, and

WHEREAS, IURA staff is highly satisfied with the quality of services provided by the Harrison Studio, and

WHEREAS, the 2026 IURA budget authorized a total of \$6,000 for community development and loan underwriting services, and

WHEREAS, on January 16, 2026, the Governance Committee reviewed this matter and recommended the following action; now, therefore, be it

RESOLVED, that IURA Chair is hereby authorized, upon review of IURA legal counsel, to execute a one-year contract extension to February 28, 2027 for independent contractor community development consulting services with H. Sicherman & Company, Inc. dba The Harrison Studio, at a maximum hourly rate of \$175 per hour with the total amount not to exceed \$8,000, and be it further

RESOLVED, that the source of such funds for community development consulting services shall be derived from a variety of funding sources, including, but not limited to, CDBG and HOME funds, and expenses shall be billed to the appropriate source of funds for which the services were performed.

Carried Unanimously: 3-0

2. Legal Services: Mariette Geldenhuys, Attorney & Mediator

Fleming explained that the second contract is with Mariette Geldenhuys, Attorney-at-Law, whose work IURA staff is highly satisfied with.

Fleming moved, seconded by Hull:

2026 Procurement of Independent Legal Services: M. Geldenhuys

WHEREAS, the contract for independent legal services with Mariette Geldenhuys, Attorney-at-Law (Geldenhuys) expires on February 28, 2026, and

WHEREAS, in accordance with IURA procurement policy and regulations contained in 2 CFR Part 200 for procurement of professional services, the IURA issued a competitive Request for Proposals for legal services on December 22, 2025, and

WHEREAS, the RFP was sent to current IURA contractors, firms that indicated prior interest or responded to prior RFPs, and published as a legal ad in the Ithaca Journal, and

WHEREAS, the IURA received the following proposals:

- Mariette Geldenhuys, Attorney-at-Law
- The Law Office of Sharon M. Sulimowicz, and

WHEREAS, per applicable procurement regulations, a contractor selected through an initial competitive selection process may be renewed for up to two additional one-year terms without undertaking a new competitive selection process, and

WHEREAS, Geldenhuys submitted a proposal to continue providing legal services to the IURA in 2026 at a maximum billing rate of \$250 per hour, a 0.0% increase from the current contract rate of \$250 per hour, and

WHEREAS, the IURA staff is highly satisfied with the quality of legal services provided by Geldenhuys, and

WHEREAS, the 2026 IURA budget recommended a total authorized contract amount of \$13,000 for legal services; and

WHEREAS, on January 16, 2026, the Governance Committee reviewed this matter and recommended the following action; now, therefore, be it

RESOLVED, that IURA Chair is hereby authorized, upon review of IURA legal counsel, to execute a one-year contract extension through February 28, 2027 for independent contractor legal services with Mariette Geldenhuys, Attorney and Mediator, at a maximum hourly rate of \$250 per hour with the total amount not to exceed \$11,000, and be it further

RESOLVED, that the source of such funds for legal services shall be derived from a variety of funding sources, including, but not limited to, CDBG and HOME funds, and expenses shall be billed to the appropriate source of funds for which the services were performed.

Carried Unanimously: 3-0

3. Legal Services: Law Office of Sharon M. Sulimowicz

Fleming explained the second legal services contract is with Sharon Sulimowicz, Attorney-at-Law, whose work IURA staff is also highly satisfied with.

Fleming moved, seconded by Hull:

2026 Procurement of Independent Legal Services: S. Sulimowicz

WHEREAS, the contract for independent legal services with The Law Office of Sharon M. Sulimowicz (Sulimowicz) expires on February 28, 2026, and

WHEREAS, in accordance with IURA procurement policy and regulations contained in 2 CFR Part 200 for procurement of professional services, the IURA issued a competitive Request for Proposals for legal services on December 22, 2025, and

WHEREAS, the RFP was sent to current IURA contractors, firms that indicated prior interest or responded to prior RFPs, and published a legal ad in the Ithaca Journal, and

WHEREAS, the IURA received the following proposals:

- Mariette Geldenhuys, Attorney-at-Law
- The Law Office of Sharon M. Sulimowicz, and

WHEREAS, per applicable procurement regulations, a contractor selected through an initial competitive selection process may be renewed for up to two additional one-year terms without undertaking a new competitive selection process, and

WHEREAS, Sulimowicz submitted a proposal to continue providing legal services to the IURA in 2026 at a maximum billing rate of \$250 per hour, an 11.0% increase from the current contract rate of \$225 per hour, and

WHEREAS, the IURA staff is highly satisfied with the quality of legal services provided by Sulimowicz, and

WHEREAS, the 2026 IURA budget recommended a total authorized contract amount of \$13,000 for legal services; and

WHEREAS, on January 16, 2026, the Governance Committee reviewed this matter and recommended the following action; now, therefore, be it

RESOLVED, that IURA Chair is hereby authorized, upon review of IURA legal counsel, to execute a one-year contract extension through February 28, 2027 for independent contractor legal services with The Law Office of Sharon M. Sulimowicz at a maximum hourly rate of \$250 per hour with the total amount not to exceed \$6,000 unless assigned a project for a Low-Income Housing Tax Credit project where the counterparty pays for IURA legal services, and be it further

RESOLVED, that the source of such funds for legal services shall be derived from a variety of funding sources, including, but not limited to, CDBG and HOME funds, and expenses shall be billed to the appropriate source of funds for which the services were performed.

Carried Unanimously: 3-0

4. Accounting Services: K. Cook

Fleming explained that the IURA Accountant has resigned to take a full-time position, but has agreed to provide transitional accounting services on an independent contractor basis.

Fleming moved, seconded by Hull:

Independent Accounting Consulting Services – K. Cook

WHEREAS, the IURA part-time Accountant has resigned to take a full-time position with January 16, 2026 as her last day of employment with the IURA, and

WHEREAS, Ms. Cook has agreed to provide transitional accounting services on an independent contractor basis through the annual IURA audit scheduled for the second week in February and to train a new IURA accountant, and

WHEREAS, an IURA search committee is currently interviewing candidates for the Accountant position and the IURA will benefit from transitional accounting services, and

WHEREAS, the current IURA Accountant earns \$40.73 plus an 11% employer contribution to retirement, and

WHEREAS, an independent contractor is responsible for both 7.65% employer and 7.65% employee FICA contributions for Social Security and Medicare, and

WHEREAS, the proposed hourly rate for transitional accounting services is:

\$40.73 hourly wage
\$4.48 payment in lieu of retirement benefit
\$6.23 FICA contributions
\$51.44/hour, and

WHEREAS, on January 16, 2026, the Governance Committee reviewed this matter and recommended the following action; now, therefore, be it

RESOLVED, that IURA Chair is hereby authorized, upon review of IURA legal counsel, to execute an independent contractor agreement with Kim Cook to provide transitional IURA accounting services through March 31, 2026 at an hourly rate of \$51.44, and be it further

RESOLVED, that the source of such funds for community development consulting services shall be derived from a variety of funding sources, including, but not limited to, CDBG and HOME funds, and expenses shall be billed to the appropriate source of funds for which the services were performed, and be it further

RESOLVED, the IURA thanks Ms. Cook for her 11 years of dedicated service to the Agency.

Carried Unanimously: 3-0

B. Hiring — Fill Vacant IURA Accountant Position

Cantelmo asked if the position's number of hours is sufficient to support the organization. Bohn replied that, in the event the workload increases over the course of a year, compensatory time would be provided to the employee.

Fleming moved, seconded by Hull:

Fill Vacant IURA Accountant Position

WHEREAS, the IURA part-time Accountant has resigned to take a full-time position with January 16, 2026 as her last day of employment with the IURA, and

WHEREAS, an IURA Accountant search committee includes the following persons:

- Shaianne Osterreich
- Kathy Schlather
- Nels Bohn
- Anisa Mendizabal, and

WHEREAS, the search committee has conducted numerous candidate interviews, and

WHEREAS, on January 16, 2026, the Governance Committee reviewed this matter and recommended the following action; now, therefore, be it

RESOLVED, the IURA Director of Community Development is hereby authorized to offer employment to the candidate recommended by the IURA search committee to fill the vacant IURA part-time Accountant position an annual 2026 salary of \$46,590.23.

Carried Unanimously: 5-0

C. Committee Chairperson Report

None.

VIII. New/Other/Old Business

A. IURA Grant, Loan, & Lease Reports: November 2025

Bohn reviewed the Grants Summary, explaining that the left-hand “On Schedule” column calls out any projects (with a **NO**) that are declining funding or not progressing on schedule and may need attention. All loan payments are current. All lease payments are current. There has been notable recent progress in spending down CDBG funds, including:

- \$44,000 voucher from Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services, Inc. (INHS) homeowner rehab program.
- \$230,000 sidewalk improvement project voucher.
- \$70,000 Cass Park bathroom reprogramming was supported by Common Council.

The IURA must spend \$600,000 in CDBG funds by the end of May, and staff are actively monitoring drawdowns.

C. REPORTS: IURA Chair/Mayor, Common Council Liaison, & Staff

IURA Chair/Mayor’s Report

Cantelmo reported the newly appointed Common Council liaison, Patrick Kuehl, will be serving on the Board over the coming year.

Common Council Liaison Report

None.

Staff Report

Bohn remarked the meeting agenda packet contains an update on the Continuum of Care’s ongoing progress in addressing homelessness.

Bohn added that the U.S. House of Representatives and Senate have conferenced in terms of appropriations, so there should be level funding for both Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Program and HOME Investment Partnerships Program (HOME).

VIII. Adjournment

The meeting was adjourned by consensus at 9:21 A.M.

— END —

Proposed Resolution
Ithaca Urban Renewal Agency
February 26, 2026

Authorize Independent Contract for Full-Charge Accounting Services - Moore

WHEREAS, the IURA part-time Accountant resigned effective January 16, 2026, creating a need for IURA accounting services, and

WHEREAS, an IURA Accountant search committee included the following persons:

- Shaianne Osterreich
- Kathy Schlather
- Nels Bohn
- Anisa Mendizabal, and

WHEREAS, the search committee conducted numerous candidate interviews and recommended hiring a preferred candidate, and

WHEREAS, IURA Human Resource policies establish that the IURA shall offer individual health insurance to a part-time employee, and

WHEREAS, the preferred candidate declined an offer of employment as a part-time IURA Accountant as she was advised that IURA employer-offered individual health insurance to her would make the candidate ineligible for subsidies for family health insurance coverage available through the NYS marketplace, and

WHEREAS, the search committee subsequently recommended engaging the preferred IURA accountant candidate through an independent contractor agreement, and

WHEREAS, the preferred candidate has conceptually agreed to provide full-charge accounting services to the IURA as an independent contractor on an annual renewal basis, and

WHEREAS, the proposed cost to hire accounting services through an independent contractor agreement at \$57/hour does not exceed the cost the IURA would incur to hire an accountant at the advertised rate of \$40.70/hour with employer benefits; now, therefore, be it

RESOLVED, that the IURA Chairperson is hereby authorized, subject to review by IURA legal counsel, to execute an independent contract agreement for full charge accounting services with Amber Moore, at a rate of \$57/hour.

Proposed Resolution
IURA
February 26, 2026

2025 Designation of Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services, Inc. (INHS)
as a Community Housing Development Organization (CHDO) and
as a Community Based Development Organization (CBDO)

WHEREAS, the Ithaca Urban Renewal Agency (IURA) has been designated by the City of Ithaca as the Lead Agency to develop, administer and implement the HUD Entitlement Grant program, including funds received through the HOME Investment Partnerships (HOME) program, and

WHEREAS, grant recipients under the HOME program are termed Participating Jurisdictions (PJs), and

WHEREAS, PJs must reserve not less than 15% of their HOME allocation for investment in housing to be developed, sponsored, or owned by Community Housing Development Organizations (CHDOs), and

WHEREAS, each PJ must annually identify CHDOs that are capable of carrying out projects to address priority housing needs identified in the Consolidated Plan, and

WHEREAS, a CHDO is a specific type of community-based non-profit organization as defined in 24 CFR §92.2, and

WHEREAS, on April 9, 2025, Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services, Inc. (INHS) submitted materials documenting its qualifications and requested renewal of its designation as a CHDO by the IURA, and

WHEREAS, on February 9, 2026, IURA Staff completed a point-in-time review of said documents, and

WHEREAS, at its February 12, 2026 meeting, the Neighborhood Investment Committee of the Ithaca Urban Renewal Agency compared the submitted materials against CHDO criteria and recommends the following; now, therefore be it

RESOLVED, that the IURA, acting in its capacity as the Lead Agency for the Participating Jurisdiction of the City of Ithaca, hereby renews its designation of Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services, Inc. as a CHDO for the 2025 Action Plan, and be it further

RESOLVED, that the IURA, acting in its capacity as the Lead Agency for the Participating Jurisdiction of the City of Ithaca, and pursuant to 24 CFR §570.204(c)(3) hereby renews its designation of Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services, Inc. as a Community Based Development Organization (CBDO) for the 2025 Action Plan, pending input from HUD.



108 East Green Street
Ithaca, New York 14850
(607) 274-6559

To: IURA Board & Committees
CC: Nels Bohn, Community Development Director; Charles Pyott, Contracts Monitor
From: Anisa Mendizabal, Community Development Planner
Re: CHDO as a CBDO – INHS Designation
Date: February 9, 2026

I. CHDO Checklist

The Checklist below indicates the documentation that INHS has provided to evidence its ability to act as a Community Housing Development Organization (CHDO).

IURA Staff reviewed the documents and has determined they meet CHDO Standards.

I. LEGAL STATUS

A. The nonprofit organization is organized under State or local laws, as evidenced by:

_____ **A Charter, OR**

__X__ **Articles of Incorporation.**

B. No part of its net earnings inure to the benefit of any member, founder, contributor, or individual, as evidenced by:

_____ **A Charter, OR**

__X__ **Articles of Incorporation.**

C. Has a tax exemption ruling from the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) under Section 501(c) of the Internal Revenue Code of 1986, as evidenced by:

__X__ **A 501(c) Certificate from the IRS.**

D. Has among its purposes the provision of decent housing that is affordable to low- and moderate-income people, as evidenced by a statement in the organization's:

_____ **Charter,**

__X__ **Articles of Incorporation,**

_____ **By-laws, OR**

_____ **Resolutions.**

_____ **A HUD approved audit summary**

II. CAPACITY

A. Conforms to the financial accountability standards of Attachment F of OMB Circular A-110, "Standards for Financial Management Systems," as evidenced by:

☒ A notarized statement by the president or chief financial officer of the organization;

☐ A certification from a Certified Public Accountant; OR

☐ A HUD approved audit summary.

B. Has a demonstrated capacity for carrying out activities assisted with HOME funds, as evidenced by:

☒ Resumes and/or statements that describe the experience of key staff members who have successfully completed projects similar to those to be assisted with HOME funds, OR

☐ Contract(s) with consulting firms or individuals who have housing experience similar to projects to be assisted with HOME funds to train appropriate key staff of the organization.

C. Has a history of serving the community where housing to be assisted with HOME funds will be used, as evidenced by:

☒ Statement that documents at least one year of experience in serving the community, OR

☐ For newly created organizations formed by local churches, service, or community organizations, a statement that documents that its parent organization has at least one year of experience in serving the community.

(continued on next page)

III. ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

- A. Maintains at least one-third of its governing board's membership for residents of low-income neighborhoods, other low-income community residents, or elected representatives of low-income neighborhood organizations, as evidenced by the organization's:

☒ By-Laws,
☐ Charter, OR
☐ Articles of Incorporation.

Under the HOME Program, for urban areas, the term "community" is defined as one or several neighborhoods, a city, county, or metropolitan area. For rural areas, "community" is defined as one or several neighborhoods, a town, village, county, or multi-county area (but not the whole state).

- B. Provides a formal process for low-income, program beneficiaries to advise the organization in all of its decisions regarding the design, siting, development, and management of all HOME-assisted affordable housing projects, as evidenced by:

☐ The organization's By-laws,
☒ Resolutions, OR
☐ A written statement of operating procedures approved by the governing body.

IV. RELATIONSHIP WITH FOR-PROFIT ENTITIES

- A. CHDO is not controlled, nor receives directions from individuals or entities seeking profit from the organization, as evidenced by:

☒ The organization's By-laws, OR
☐ A Memorandum of Understanding (MOU).

- B. A CHDO may be sponsored or created by a for-profit entity, however: Not applicable

- (1) The for-profit entity's primary purpose does not include the development or management of housing, as evidenced by:

☐ The for-profit organization's By-laws

AND;

- (2) The CHDO is free to contract for goods and services from vendor(s) of its own choosing, as evidenced by the CHDO's:

☐ By-Laws,
☐ Charter, OR
☐ Articles of Incorporation.

II. CHDO Board Composition Requirements

CHDO designation requires 33% of the applicant organization's board members to meet one of three qualifying criteria (discussed in depth in Section III, below). INHS's amended by-laws (2021) state that its Board is to be comprised of *up to* 15 members. There are currently 11 INHS Board Members. For the purposes of calculation, we divide 100% by the existing number of board members (11). Each member constitutes 9% of the Board.

To meet the 33% threshold of CHDO-qualified board members, INHS needs at least four (4) members to be able to self-certify in one of the three CHDO board composition categories. Seven (7) of INHS's Board Members were identified as qualified in one of the categories. Of the number, all seven (7) live in Ithaca/Tompkins County. IURA Staff verified that five (5) of the INHS Board Members live in an LMI neighborhood inside of the City. (See further explanation in Section III). These members constitute 45% of the board, exceeding the 33% test. Another member who lives outside of Ithaca but inside of Tompkins County, meets the "other Low-Income Community Resident" threshold. (The seventh member no longer lives in an LMI neighborhood, according to HUD data). With six members qualifying, 54% of the INHS Board qualifies.

III. CDBO vs. CHDO Board Composition Requirements

- A. HUD's Board Composition requirements for Community-Based Development Organizations (CBDOs) and Community Housing Development Organizations (CHDOs) are similar but not the same. Both types of designation require that the organization serve an LMI community (-ies). Both require organizations to demonstrate that a certain portion of their board has personal or professional ties to the community being served-- for a CBDO, at least 51% of board members must qualify under the self-certification standards whereas for a CHDO, at least 33% is required. The self-certification criteria for the two designations have key differences, which are summarized in the chart below.

CBDO Board Composition	CHDO Board Composition
A - LMI Resident of Service Area [Individual]	A - Resident of LMI ¹ Neighborhood ²
B - Business Owner/Sr. Officer of Institution in Service Area	B - Other Low-Income Community Member
C - Representative of an LMI Neighborhood Org	C - Elected ³ Rep of LMI Neighborhood Assn [requires election]

¹ Note that in this category, the board member themselves is not required to *be* LMI, only to *reside* in a majority-LMI neighborhood.

² If the CHDO serves a rural area, the "neighborhood" could be outside PJ or Tompkins County. The application needs to be sure to obtain the Income Limits documentation appropriate each certifying board member's residential neighborhood.

- B. Another difference between the two designations is that the service area for a CBDO is generally contained within the Participating Jurisdiction, while HUD guidelines allow for CHDOs to have a broader reach, especially if the CHDO serves a rural area. Therefore, a rural CHDO may draw board members from a multi-county service area.

Under the HOME program, for urban areas, the term "community" is defined as one or several neighborhoods, a city, county, or metropolitan area. For rural areas, "community" is defined as one or several neighborhoods, a town, village, county, or multi-county area (but not the whole state).

- CPD Notice 97-11: Guidance on CHDOs under the HOME Program (supersedes CPD Notice 94-02)

- C. These factors have an implication for the IURA CHDO/CBDO Review Process.
1. IURA has had a practice of certifying our CHDO specifically for the PJ's service area (City of Ithaca).
 2. IURA will continue to attempt to reach the certification threshold by analyzing the qualifying criteria of board members whose self-certification involves Ithaca (the PJ).
 - a. If the threshold for certification is not met after analyzing Ithaca-centered board members, qualifications of board members living outside the PJ will be analyzed.
 - b. The complexity of documenting and qualifying board members outside of the PJ (and, next level, Tompkins County) contributes to IURA's rationale for this method.
 - i. Income Qualification: The City of Ithaca's HUD Income Limits = Tompkins County's Income Limits (they are the same). INHS has board members living outside of Tompkins County. They will need to provide proof they qualify in their appropriate City/County.
 - ii. Link to HUD Income Limits:
<https://www.huduser.gov/portal/datasets/il.html>
 - iii. LMI Neighborhoods: Similarly, board members seeking to qualify as a Resident of an LMI neighborhood will need to provide proof to us via HUD census or HUD's Low- and Moderate-Income Area Data Mapping Application.
 - iv. Link to LMI Area Mapping Application⁴:
<https://hud.maps.arcgis.com/home/item.html?id=279eca0222754f8a954bbf8cf995a1a3#overview>

³ CHDO's "elected" representative is higher bar than the CBDO standard, which does not specify that the representative be elected.

⁴ HUD indicates there was an October 18, 2024 update to this map which uses 2026-2020 data.

IV. Substantial Similarity: A Regulatory Pathway for Certifying a CHDO as a CBDO

- A. 24 CFR 570.204 – Special Activities by Community-Based Development Organizations (CBDOs) **paragraph (c)(1)** describes the general process by which community organizations may be designated a CBDO, a process familiar to IURA’s Neighborhood Investment Committee and Board.
- B. Paragraph (c)(2) and (3) describe other pathways for designation as a CBDO. These paragraphs are included below, with emphasis added to facilitate discussion.
- (2) A CBDO that does not meet the criteria in [paragraph \(c\)\(1\)](#) of this section may also qualify as an eligible entity under this section if it meets one of the following requirements:
- (i) Is an entity organized pursuant to section 301(d) of the [Small Business Investment Act of 1958 \(15 U.S.C. 681\(d\)\)](#), including those which are profit making; or
- (ii) Is an SBA approved Section 501 State Development Company or Section 502 Local Development Company, or an SBA Certified Section 503 Company under the [Small Business Investment Act of 1958](#), as amended; or
- (iii) Is a Community Housing Development Organization (CHDO) under [24 CFR 92.2](#), designated as a CHDO by the HOME Investment Partnerships program participating jurisdiction, with a geographic area of operation *of no more than one neighborhood, and has received HOME funds under [24 CFR 92.300](#) or is expected to receive HOME funds as described in and documented in accordance with [24 CFR 92.300\(e\)](#).*
- (3) A CBDO that does not qualify under paragraph (c)(1) or (2) of this section may also be determined to qualify as an eligible entity under this section if the [recipient](#) demonstrates to the satisfaction of HUD, through the provision of information regarding the organization’s charter and by-laws, that the organization is sufficiently similar in purpose, function, and scope to those entities qualifying under paragraph (c)(1) or (2) of this section.**
- [[60 FR 1944](#), Jan. 5, 1995, as amended at [71 FR 30035](#), May 24, 2006; [81 FR 92636](#), Dec. 20, 2016]
- C. IURA Staff have analyzed INHS’ application and documentation and have determined that INHS does qualify as a CHDO. However, INHS’s service area is now larger than that described at (c)(2)(iii).
- INHS was founded in Ithaca and has served Ithaca as a CHDO since Ithaca was designated an Entitlement Community in 2004.
 - INHS previously qualified as a CBDO.
 - IURA Staff have determined that through review of its charter and by-laws that it is sufficiently similar in purpose, function, and scope to a CBDO.

- d. IURA Staff has provided the above information to HUD for input since 2023.

Multifamily Finance 2025 9% RFP - Project Awards

Project ID	REDC	Awardee & Project Name	Project County & Municipality	9% Low Income Housing Tax Credit (LIHTC)	State Low Income Housing Credit (SLIHC)	HOME ARP Program (HOME)	Housing Trust Fund (HTF)	Rural & Urban Community Investment Fund (CIF)	Public Housing Preservation Program (PHP)	Senior Housing Program (SENR)	Supportive Housing Opportunity Program (SHOP)	New Construction Program (NCP)	Clean Energy Initiative (CEI)	Multifamily Solar Program (MFS)	Residential Units
20250469	Capital Region	RISE Housing and Support Services, Inc. The Finley	Saratoga City of Saratoga Springs	\$2,319,669							\$7,280,000				71
20250511	Capital Region	Beacon Communities Services LLC Excelsior Apartments	Saratoga City of Saratoga Springs	\$1,900,000	\$383,007		\$5,000,000							\$186,055	50
20250513	Capital Region	DePaul Properties, Inc. SCAP Campus Apartments	Schenectady City of Schenectady	\$2,241,058							\$4,600,000				60
20250503	Central NY	Lakewood Development III, LLC Marcellus Senior Apartments	Onondaga Town of Marcellus	\$1,925,000	\$1,000,000					\$4,732,462			\$910,000		72
20250507	Central NY	Regan Development Corporation Cortlandville Commons	Cortland Town of Cortlandville	\$2,134,143			\$6,000,000	\$1,130,000							68
20250523	Central NY	Eagle Star Housing, Inc. Jordan Landing	Onondaga Village of Jordan (Town of Elbridge)	\$2,200,000	\$490,483						\$6,950,000				65
20250472	Finger Lakes	PathStone Housing Action Corp. Midvale Commons Phase 2	Monroe Town of Perinton	\$972,921	\$570,000					\$2,960,000					28
20250470	Long Island	Northville Commons LLC Northville Commons	Suffolk Town of Riverhead	\$2,810,000	\$348,356	\$5,000,000	\$4,000,000								80
20250474	Long Island	Georgica Green Ventures LLC Dogwood Terrace	Nassau Town of Hempstead	\$3,000,000	\$771,180			\$896,545	\$10,000,000	\$4,560,000					104
20250482	Long Island	The D & F Development Group, LLC Alegria South	Suffolk Town of Brookhaven	\$3,100,000	\$760,773			\$400,000				\$9,000,000			96
20250501	Long Island	The D & F Development Group, LLC Bishop Ronald H. Carter Manor	Nassau Village of Freeport (Town of Hempstead)	\$3,000,000	\$316,268							\$9,000,000			80
20250461	Mid-Hudson	Rehabilitation Support Services, Inc. Stone Creek Commons	Ulster Town of Saugerties	\$1,198,539				\$400,000			\$4,700,000				47
20250478	Mid-Hudson	Access: Supports For Living Inc. Ridgeview Apartments	Orange Town of Crawford	\$1,155,000	\$408,454	\$2,445,000					\$1,755,000				42
20250488	Mid-Hudson	Parkview Development & Construction, LLC Hallstead Farms	Dutchess Town of LaGrange	\$2,500,000	\$685,463		\$3,978,319								72
20250462	Mohawk Valley	Rockton Plaza New Construction LLC Rockton Plaza New Construction	Herkimer City of Little Falls	\$2,050,417			\$3,740,000							\$125,235	44
20250468	Mohawk Valley	Rehabilitation Support Services, Inc. Solstice Commons Apartments	Otsego City of Oneonta	\$1,677,500							\$5,919,550			\$155,035	61
20250531	Mohawk Valley	DePaul Properties, Inc. Columbia Square Apartments	Oneida City of Utica	\$2,100,000	\$525,809						\$6,400,000				66
20250463	New York City	Building Archer Avenue DD Housing Development Fund Corporation Archer Avenue Apartments	Queens City of New York	\$2,571,994							\$12,700,000				127
20250475	New York City	United Cerebral Palsy Association of NYS, Inc. 2863 Atlantic	Kings City of New York	\$2,783,788							\$1,383,337	\$6,986,623			70
20250521	New York City	Bench Vyse LLC 1848 Vyse	Bronx City of New York	\$2,783,042							\$6,512,113				119
20250505	North Country	Regan Development Corporation Fireman's Field Apartments	Essex Town of Ticonderoga	\$2,000,000	\$413,828	\$1,290,000	\$4,700,000	\$1,290,000							60
20250476	Southern Tier	SCAP d/b/a Arbor Housing & Development Southport Corners	Chemung Town of Southport	\$1,650,000	\$1,000,000		\$5,714,388								60
20250520	Southern Tier	Young Womens Christian Association of Binghamton and Broome County YWCA Intergenerational Campus	Broome City of Binghamton	\$2,353,528	\$388,027			\$2,000,000			\$6,800,000			\$249,999	68
20250528	Southern Tier	Housing Visions Consultants, Inc. Parish Heights	Steuben City of Corning	\$1,100,000	\$487,906		\$3,271,859	\$500,000					\$430,000		45
20250464	Western NY	Belmont Housing Resources for WNY, Inc. McCoy-Young Commons	Erie City of Buffalo	\$1,647,500	\$606,092		\$2,230,000					\$1,013,377			49
20250479	Western NY	Park Grove Development, LLC Sanborn Square	Niagara Town of Lewiston	\$1,700,000	\$347,950		\$4,120,000								50
20250502	Western NY	Citizens Opportunity For Development & Equality Inc. Blooming Gardens	Chautauqua City of Jamestown	\$1,550,000	\$496,404	\$1,265,000	\$245,434						\$645,000		44
TOTALS:				\$56,424,099	\$10,000,000	\$10,000,000	\$43,000,000	\$6,616,545	\$10,000,000	\$12,252,462	\$65,000,000	\$26,000,000	\$1,985,000	\$716,324	1,798

2026 HUD Entitlement Program (City of Ithaca, NY) – Funding Proposals Received

(grey boxes = not eligible under that column/program)

Last Updated: 2/24/26

#	Project	Sponsor	Funding Request	Matching Funds (Sec. & Unsec.)	Total Project Cost	ANTICIPATED AVAILABLE FUNDING				Project Summary Description
						Total CDBG	Total HOME	2026 CDBG PI	TOTAL	
						\$841,000	\$232,000.00	\$160,000	\$1,073,000	
HOUSING										
1	The Citizen	Rochester Management, Inc. (RMI)	\$ 100,000	\$36,609,244	\$ 36,709,244				\$ -	Funds for construction of 59 permanently affordable and supportive housing units in downtown Ithaca.
2	Henry St. John Residential Building Renovation*	Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services, Inc. (INHS)	\$ 199,900	\$4,552,340	\$ 4,752,240				\$ -	Funds towards rehabilitation of Henry St. John Building, resulting in all-electric building with updated interior and restored historic exterior, increasing number of units from 12 to 16 high quality affordable housing units.
3	Minor Repair Program	Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services, Inc. (INHS)	\$ 45,000	\$161,268	\$ 206,268				\$ -	Funding towards salary/benefits to provide at least 40 LMI homeowners with maintenance and repairs focused on health/safety issues, accessibility, and providing links to other programs and services.
4	Housing Scholarship Program	The Learning Web, Inc.	\$ 91,404	\$84,494	\$ 175,898				\$ -	Funds will be used for Tenant-Based Rental Assistance and utilities for unaccompanied homeless youth in 5 scattered site apartments chosen and leased by the youth.
5	Security Deposit Assistance for Vulnerable Households	Catholic Charities of Tompkins/Tioga Counties	\$ 96,000	\$27,940	\$ 123,940				\$ -	Funding towards security deposits for 92 LMI households (incl. elderly, disabled, single parents) at risk of homelessness to access safe/stable housing and avoid/end homelessness.
6	The Ross House	The REACH Project, Inc.	\$ 100,000	\$3,692,139	\$ 3,792,139				\$ -	Funding for renovation of 618 W. State St. to create 10 units of permanent supportive housing for individuals experiencing homelessness. <u>Note: The Davis-Bacon Act to HOME projects with 11 or fewer units and CDBG projects with 7 or fewer units.</u> [flood prevention analysis required & lease term question]
HOUSING SUBTOTAL:			\$ 632,304	\$ 45,127,425	\$ 45,759,729	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	
ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT										
7	Coordinated Pathways to Permanent Local Employment	Finger Lakes ReUse, Inc.	\$ 65,132	\$191,425	\$ 256,557				\$ -	Funding of job-training opportunities for LMI populations, including placement of at least 10 individuals into permanent unsubsidized employment.
8	Hospitality Employment Training Program (HETP)	Greater Ithaca Activities Center, Inc. (GIAC)	\$ 100,000	\$106,142	\$ 206,142				\$ -	Funding for job-training of 20 underemployed adults with barriers to employment, including 14 placements into hospitality, customer service, office, and childcare related jobs.
[#]	Economic Development Loan Fund	IURA	\$ 160,000	\$ -	\$ 160,000				\$ -	Capitalize loan fund for business loans resulting in job creation (including underwriting and delivery).
ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT SUBTOTAL:			\$ 325,132	\$ 297,567	\$ 622,699	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	
PUBLIC FACILITIES/INFRASTRUCTURE										
9	Pathways to Home: Purchasing the Village House	The Village at Ithaca	\$ 125,000	\$400,000	\$ 525,000				\$ -	Funds towards acquisition of property that provides safe/stable transitional housing for low-income young adults experiencing homelessness.
10	Floral Avenue Pedestrian & Cyclist Safety	City of Ithaca	\$ 94,000	\$5,000	\$ 99,000				\$ -	Funds towards materials/construction and staff time to improve pedestrian/cyclist safety through installation of 3 raised crosswalks to slow traffic on Floral Ave.
11	Wharton/DPW Building ADA Improvements	Friends of Stewart Park	\$ 99,899	\$10,000	\$ 109,899				\$ -	Funds towards demolition/construction to address existing barriers to access for people with disabilities, mobility challenges, and older visitors, significantly enhancing park's usability.
PUBLIC FACILITIES SUBTOTAL:			\$318,899	\$ 415,000	\$ 733,899	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	
PUBLIC SERVICES										
Public Services Funding Cap = 15% of CDBG Award: \$102,150.00										
12	Housing Scholarship Program Personnel Support (connected to #4 above)	The Learning Web, Inc.	\$ 34,633	\$84,494	\$ 119,127				\$ -	Funds will be used for a portion of case management, mental health counseling, and administrative oversight needed to support participants and administrate the Housing Scholarship Program.
13	Staffing Assistance for Security Deposit Clients	Catholic Charities of Tompkins/Tioga Counties	\$ 15,000	\$5,530	\$ 20,530				\$ -	Funding towards staffing costs to assist homeless and near-homeless households with security deposit funds.
14	Improving Essential Low-Cost Transportation Access	Ithaca Bikeshare	\$ 40,000	\$40,625	\$ 80,625				\$ -	Funding towards purchase of new e-bikes and rechargeable batteries to increase availability/quality of Ithaca Bikeshare's e-bike fleet, assisting 210 LMI individuals.
15	Bridging the Gap: Employment Services for Individuals in All Forms of Recovery	Service in Unity	\$ 20,000	\$61,000	\$ 81,000				\$ -	Funding towards staff salaries, payroll taxes, insurance, and administrative support for LMI individuals in all forms of recovery.
16	2-1-1 Information & Referral Helpline with Housing Navigation	Human Services Coalition of Tompkins County, Inc. (HSC)	\$ 22,000	\$22,000	\$ 44,000				\$ -	Funding towards staff salaries and fringe benefits to provide essential personnel coverage for the 2-1-1 contact center, benefiting at least 2,870 households.
17	Mobile Bike Repair Clinic	Bike Walk Tompkins (Center for Community Transportation)	\$ 30,000	\$100,800	\$ 130,800				\$ -	Funding towards salaries, safety equipment (helmets, locks, lights), and pop-up repair clinics thereby increasing access to bicycles as an affordable form of transportation for at least 60 LMI households.
18	Enhance Local Tenants Rights Education & Connection to Services	Cornell Cooperative Extension (CCE)	\$ 20,000	\$3,400	\$ 23,400				\$ -	Funding towards staff time and printing/marketing to increase access to local tenant services for at least 17,222 LMI households.
19	ReUse Materials Access Program for Ithaca Households in Need	Finger Lakes ReUse, Inc.	\$ 27,703	\$78,365	\$ 106,068				\$ -	Funding towards staffing and essential materials/delivery services benefiting at least 120 vulnerable LMI households.
PUBLIC SERVICES SUBTOTAL:			\$ 209,336	\$ 396,214	\$ 605,550	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	
ADMINISTRATION										
20	CDBG Administration (20%)	IURA	\$ 136,200	\$ -	\$136,200	\$ 136,200			\$ 136,200	Planning, administration, and monitoring for CDBG program.
21	HOME Administration (10%)	IURA	\$ 23,200	\$ -	\$23,200		\$ 23,200		\$ 23,200	Planning, administration, and monitoring for HOME program.
ADMINISTRATION SUBTOTAL:			\$ 159,400	\$ -	\$ 159,400	\$ 136,200.00	\$ 23,200.00	\$ -	\$ 159,400.00	R/U = Recaptured/Unallocated (from prior years) LMI = Low & Moderate Income (80% or less of AMI) AMI = Area Median Income (Tompkins County) FTE = Full-Time Equivalent PI = Program Income
TOTALS:			\$ 1,645,070.93	\$ 46,236,206.00	\$ 47,881,276.93	\$238,350.00	\$23,200.00	\$0.00	\$ 159,400.00	

Minimum Required Set-Aside of HOME Funds for CHDO Activities (15%): \$34,800.00

*CHDO Set-Aside Eligible Projects: 1

HOME (R/U): \$12,052.48 --> \$6,055.80 from 2024 HOME commitment to The Beacon and \$5,996.68

2026 CITY OF ITHACA HUD ENTITLEMENT GRANT Action Plan Schedule

① Please note this schedule is subject to change without advance notice. Check IURA website for most up-to-date version.
2/5/2026

MILESTONE	DATE/LOCATION
PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT (VIRTUAL-ONLY OPPORTUNITY)	9:30 A.M., Wednesday, December 3, 2025, CoC Homeless & Housing Task Force (Virtual Only). Zoom link at: https://hsctc.org/providers/
ORGANIZATIONAL MEETING(S)	9:00 A.M., Thursday, December 11, 2025, NIC Mtg. & 9:00 A.M., Thursday, December 18, 2025, IURA Board Mtg., Common Council Chambers, City Hall (3 rd FL.)
CALL FOR FUNDING PROPOSALS ISSUED	MONDAY, JANUARY 5, 2026
PUBLIC INFORMATION & INPUT MEETING #1 (HYBRID MTG.)	12:00 Noon-1:00 P.M., Tuesday, January 13, 2026, Common Council Chambers, City Hall (HYBRID mtg). Zoom link at: www.IthacaURA.org
PUBLIC INFORMATION & INPUT MEETING #2 (IN-PERSON MTG.)	5:00 P.M.-6:00 P.M., Thursday, January 15, 2026, Borg Warner Room East, Tompkins County Public Library (IN-PERSON ONLY)
INPUT, CONSULTATION & TECHNICAL ASSISTANCE (BY REQUEST)	Contact Anisa Mendizabal for availability: amendizabal@cityofithaca.org or (213) 220-3522.
PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT MEETINGS - ADDITIONAL	<i>IURA Staff may set additional Public Engagement Meetings.</i>
FUNDING APPLICATIONS DUE:	NOON, FEBRUARY 20, 2026
Neighborhood Investment Committee Meeting #1	1:00 P.M., Thursday, March 5, 2026 Common Council Chambers, City Hall
Economic Development Committee Meeting #1	3:30 P.M., Tuesday, March 10, 2026 Common Council Chambers, City Hall
Neighborhood Investment Committee Meeting #2	1:00 P.M., Thursday, March 12, 2026 Common Council Chambers, City Hall
IURA BOARD MEETING #1 — PUBLIC HEARING #1	1:00 P.M.- 4:30 P.M., Thursday, March 19, 2026 Common Council Chambers, City Hall
IURA BOARD MEETING #2 — PUBLIC HEARING #1 (CONT.)	1:00 P.M.- 4:30 P.M., Thursday, March 26, 2026 Common Council Chambers, City Hall
Neighborhood Investment Committee Meeting #3	1:00 P.M., Thursday, April 9, 2026 Common Council Chambers, City Hall
Economic Development Committee Meeting #2	3:30 P.M., Tuesday, April 14, 2026 Common Council Chambers, City Hall
Neighborhood Investment Committee Meeting #4 (IF NEEDED)	1:00 P.M., Thursday, April 16, 2026 Common Council Chambers, City Hall
IURA BOARD MEETING #3	1:00 P.M.- 4:30 P.M., Thursday, April 23, 2026 Common Council Chambers, City Hall
IURA Adoption of Draft 2026 Action Plan	1:00 P.M., Thursday, April 23, 2026
Draft 2026 Action Plan Available for 30+ Day Public Comment Period (at: www.IthacaURA.org)	12:00 Noon, Thursday, April 30, 2026
PUBLIC HEARING #2 — Common Council Committee of the Whole (COW): Special Topics Working Session	6:00 P.M., Wednesday, May 13, 2026
Close 30+ Day Comment Period on Draft Plan	12:00 Noon., Monday, June 1, 2026
Common Council Approves 2025 Action Plan	6:00 P.M., Wednesday, June 3, 2026